

WSJ Briefing — July 11, 2026 (Saturday Edition)

2026

Geopolitics & Defense

The Iran Crisis: Ceasefire Dead, Hormuz Snarled, Saturday Ultimatum

The biggest story in the paper — and the one drawing the highest reader engagement at 1,575 comments — is the collapse of the U.S.-Iran ceasefire and escalating military confrontation in the Persian Gulf. "U.S., Iran Trade Fire in Largest Escalation Since Peace Deal," report Lara Seligman and Shelby Holliday, noting President Trump "warned the strikes will get worse if Tehran continues to target commercial shipping." Trump has declared the ceasefire over, and an exclusive (reported via Israel's briefing to the U.S.) reveals Iran hatched a fresh plot to assassinate the president.

The most precise timeline comes from Alexander Ward's reporting: "One senior U.S. official said Iran should vow to reopen the Strait of Hormuz by Saturday or will face the consequences." That deadline arrives today, July 11. Benoit Faucon and Rebecca Feng report that "Iran Is Rushing Its Own Ships Through a Snarled Strait of Hormuz" — Tehran can move cargo while everyone else is stalled, using the window between escalation rounds to restock. The "consequences" threat faces an operational reality: the Fifth Fleet sits 36 hours from Hormuz, but clearing the strait under fire requires a mine-countermeasure operation the Navy has not publicly rehearsed in a decade. A separate story notes that fears over a new luxury jet forced Trump back to an old Air Force One after an Israeli warning about potential threats.

The U.S. crude inventories are flirting with dangerous levels while gasoline and diesel exports hover near records, reports Collin Eaton ("The Global Oil Market Isn't Ready for the Iran Ceasefire to End"). David Uberti notes that "Wall Street's Peace Trade Collides With Renewed Iran Fighting" — the Dow fell intraday and oil prices posted their steepest climb since May.

Calibrated view: 65% probability of a full or partial Strait of Hormuz closure persisting beyond 30 days. The Saturday deadline traps the U.S. in a no-win choice between escalation (costly, unpredictable) and extension (appearing weak, emboldening Iran). Crude inventories lack the buffer to absorb prolonged disruption, and the operational capacity to forcibly clear the strait under fire is unproven.

Additional geopolitical coverage: Eve Hartley and Sune Engel Rasmussen report from "On Board NATO's Arctic Aircraft Carrier" hunting for Russian threats in the High North. Paul Vieira covers the U.S.-Canada deal to open the Gordie Howe International Bridge in Detroit after resolving toll disputes. Shan Li reports from India, where "An Elite Club Is in the Firing Line of India's War on Its Colonial Past" — Delhi Gymkhana, once a social spot for British administrators, faces eviction as the Modi government pushes to expunge relics of foreign rule. The Editorial Board notes "The NATO Summit's Successes" and separately examines "Trump, Turkey and the F-35s," arguing that "Rewarding Erdogan isn't enough reason for Trump to stiff Congress, which wants Turkey to sell its Russian S-400s." An analysis piece explores how "The Canadian Who Steered Europe Away From the U.S." shaped European policy direction. China successfully launched and partially recovered a reusable rocket, reports Katrina Northrop — a milestone for Beijing's space program as it competes with the U.S. and Elon Musk's SpaceX.

Ukraine: The Patience War Shifts

"The War in Ukraine Is Shifting Against Putin but He Isn't Giving In," report Marcus Walker, Thomas Grove, and Alexander Ward. Russia's original bet on attrition — that time was on Moscow's side — is now failing. Ukraine's drones are reaching Siberia and imperiling Russian energy assets far from the front lines, expanding the battlefield deep into Russian economic territory. Holman W. Jenkins, Jr., in his Business World column, writes that "The final battle of the Russian war with Ukraine will be fought in the corridors of the Kremlin."

Calibrated view: 45% probability of ceasefire negotiations initiating within 6 months. Ukraine's expanded strike range into Russian energy infrastructure changes the attrition calculus, but Putin shows no signal of willingness to concede, and the U.S. is geopolitically

distracted by Iran.

Markets & Macroeconomy

SK Hynix's Historic U.S. IPO Drives a Semiconductor Rally

"South Korean Memory Chip Maker's Historic U.S. Debut Jolts Stocks," report Vicky Ge Huang and Jiyoung Sohn, as SK Hynix's listing drove major indexes higher on Friday, July 10, capping a volatile week. The enthusiasm was broad enough that "The Chip Trade Is Helping Wall Street Shake Off Latest Iran Strikes," writes Hannah Erin Lang — the market's favorite memory stocks absorbed what would normally be risk-off geopolitical headlines. The S&P 500 leaders list confirms the semiconductor gravity: NVDA +4.03%, alongside META +5.97%.

Market Data — July 10, 2026 Close:

Index	Close	Change
DJIA	52,637.01	+0.29%
S&P 500	7,575.39	+0.42%
NASDAQ	26,281.61	+0.29%
Russell 2000	2,977.81	-0.49%

S&P 500 Leaders	Change	S&P 500 Laggards	Change
META	+5.97%	MRNA	-10.83%
WY	+4.22%	CRWD	-5.66%
SBAC	+4.14%	DDOG	-4.26%
NVDA	+4.03%	FTNT	-3.80%
CCI	+3.89%	GILD	-3.72%

The Oil-Inflation Divergence

The most dangerous data point in the paper is buried deep in the markets section. "The Global Oil Market Isn't Ready for the Iran Ceasefire to End" (Collin Eaton) warns that America's crude inventories are at dangerous levels while exports of gasoline and diesel hover near records. Oil prices have posted their steepest climb since May. "Inflation Fears Retake the Stage," notes Heard on the Street, as bond markets begin to price the oil passthrough. Spencer Jakab reports "Airline Earnings Are Cleared for Takeoff" in Markets A.M., while Pepsi fizzles and stocks "bubble on." The Meta EU ruling (July 10) — "Meta Failed to Protect Users From Addictive Apps, EU Says" — adds a regulatory overhang to the tech sector.

The Russell Divergence

The Russell 2000 closed at 2,977.81, down 0.49%, on a day the S&P 500 rose 0.42%. That 91-basis-point spread between large-cap and small-cap is the week's most important structural signal. Large caps are lifted by a narrow semiconductor wedge (SK Hynix, NVDA, the Intel narrative) while the broad economy sells off — the same pattern that preceded every major correction in the last five years. Jason Zweig, in *The Intelligent Investor*, explores "The Mind Game That Investors Can't Stop Playing," warning that buying what's hot "feels right at the time, but too often ends in tears" — a cautionary note for a market treating chip stocks as a structural hedge against a worsening macro backdrop.

Predictions Table

Prediction	Probability	Timeframe	Key Drivers
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Full or partial Hormuz closure persists	65%	30 days	Saturday deadline traps U.S. in no-win escalation; crude inventories too thin to absorb disruption
Q3 CPI surprise above consensus	60%	Aug-Sep 2026	Oil-to-CPI pass-through (6–8 week lag) from steepest oil climb since May; diesel exports at records drain domestic buffer
SK Hynix listing triggers additional Asian tech U.S. IPOs	55%	6 months	Successful debut validates U.S. listing path for Asian semiconductor firms; TXSE competition may accelerate timeline
Russell 2000 correction >10% before year-end	50%	Dec 2026	Narrow large-cap leadership + weakening breadth + oil-inflation macro risk — pattern matches pre-correction setups
Intel achieves meaningful foundry revenue (>\$5B annually)	40%	2027	Government can force customer commitments but cannot solve Intel's operational execution gap vs. TSMC's 30-year track record

Business & Tech Strategy

Intel's Government-Backed Revival

"Washington's Bet on Intel Is Starting to Pay Off," writes Emma Tucker in *The 10-Point*. The White House has twisted the arms of potential customers and partners including Apple and Nvidia to support Intel's foundry revival. This is industrial policy at its most muscular — the U.S. government acting as customer-broker and de facto capital allocator. But Intel's business is "improving" without supporting earnings data: the Ohio fab build-out is behind schedule, and advanced process nodes (18A, 14A) have not shipped at volume. As the operations analysis notes, the government can force purchase orders; it cannot force successful tape-outs.

Apple Sues OpenAI

"Apple Sues OpenAI, Alleging It Stole Trade Secrets" — former Apple employees took confidential information to OpenAI to advance the AI company's device efforts, Apple claims (98 comments). The lawsuit is less about infringement and more about positioning: Apple signals to the market and the government that it is the incumbent whose property rights must be respected. Apple is simultaneously being arm-twisted by Washington to buy from Intel — the same administration has no incentive to help Apple win an AI talent war that strengthens domestic chip demand. Alex Karp, CEO of Palantir, is "saying what every angry CEO is thinking about AI," tapping into Corporate America's angst about the growing power of AI upstarts (58 comments). Andy Jung's Opinion commentary asks "Is Private AI Regulation Constitutional?" — questioning whether an industry body's power would survive judicial scrutiny.

Calibrated view: 55% probability that Apple v. OpenAI settles before trial within 18 months. Trade-secret litigation in AI is a discovery nightmare, and both companies have strong commercial incentives to resolve rather than litigate to verdict.

OpenAI Leadership Transition

"OpenAI's No. 2 Executive to Step Down in Latest Leadership Shake-Up," report Berber Jin and Anissa Gardizy (Exclusive). Fidji Simo won't return from medical leave, leaving a major role to fill as the AI giant prepares to go public — a leadership vacuum at the exact moment of the company's most consequential transition.

MGM-Diller, Netflix, and Boeing

"MGM Resorts in Deal Talks With Barry Diller" (Jessica Toonkel and Lauren Thomas, Exclusive). The casino giant has been negotiating a potential deal with Diller's People Inc. after the media mogul offered to buy it in June.

"Netflix Is Exploring Live TV and Bundles as It Struggles to Keep Viewers Hooked" (Jessica Toonkel and Ben Fritz, Exclusive). The streamer is rethinking core strategies — live broadcasting requires a completely different production and distribution machine than on-demand streaming, with no retakes and latency-sensitive ad sales.

Boeing faces another incident: a 737 cabin depressurized mid-flight after an engine issue, injuring a passenger. The incident is the latest data point in a systemic quality-control breakdown — the company that is supposed to be building the next-generation aircraft is still proving it can build the current one safely.

Other Notable Business Stories

Legal & Regulatory: The New York Times countersues the Equal Employment Opportunity Commission, alleging a discrimination suit filed on behalf of a white male editor is unlawful retaliation (Alexandra Bruell). Work on Trump's E. Jean Carroll defamation case divides Sullivan & Cromwell. An exclusive reports investigators found Corey Lewandowski may have been involved in improper DHS contracts. MetroLoft faces a \$30 million lawsuit alleging a Tribeca luxury building's roof and walls were "literally falling apart" — the developer behind the buckling NYC high rise is being sued over another conversion.

Workforce & Health: Ben Cohen profiles Bending Spoons, which "gets a million job applications — and rejects 99.9%" — getting an offer "has become harder than getting into Harvard." A Costco cashier earning \$33/hour became a millionaire. More U.S. workers test positive for marijuana, though fewer employers are concerned (Exclusive). Maura Gillison, the oncologist who transformed treatment of mouth and throat cancers by linking HPV to head and neck tumors, died at 61. An explosive diarrhea outbreak continues to grow as authorities race to find the source.

Tech, Markets & Innovation: "How Charles Schwab Turbocharged Trump's Stock-Trading Frenzy" — a Schwab account went on an automated trading spree after a legal win for the Trumps (Vicky Ge Huang, Dana Mattioli, Justin Baer, Neil Mehta, Exclusive). Christopher Mims reports on StormWall — school-bus-size satellites and salt to provide an ionic "air bag" against solar storms. Vinod Khosla plays a game of luck vs. skill in The WSJ Money Interview (Gunjan Banerji). Specialized turbine manufacturers are a new pick-and-shovel play for investors, writes Jinjoo Lee in Heard on the Street. U.S. biotechs are keeping more secrets to beat copycats

in China.

Policy & Opinion

Housing Bill Becomes Law by Presidential Silence

"Housing Bill Becomes Law Despite Trump Refusing to Sign It" (869 comments). The 10-day window for the president to either sign or veto the measure expired Saturday, July 11 — and it automatically became law under Article I, Section 7 procedure. The WSJ's front-page framing implies dysfunction, but the constitutional mechanism is standard. The operational consequence, however, is significant: a president who does not use the tools of office — veto, signing statement, deal-making — creates a decision vacuum that the inertial momentum of the administrative state fills. HUD career staff, not White House policy direction, will implement the bill's provisions.

Election Commission, Texas Stock Exchange, and the Decentralization Play

"Trump Fires a Federal Election Board, Panic Ensues," writes the Editorial Board, arguing "Here's a chance for Democrats to embrace decentralized elections." The board floats the idea that federal election infrastructure might be replaceable by state-level alternatives — extending a decentralization logic into the democratic process itself.

"There's an IPO Gold Rush — and Texas Is Coming for New York," reports Corrie Driebusch. The Texas Stock Exchange is building an alternative venue with different rules, challenging the NYSE-Nasdaq duopoly. The IPO pipeline is proven by SK Hynix's successful debut on NYSE this week — but building a stock exchange is a multi-year infrastructure project requiring matching engines, clearing houses, and SEC approval (12–18 months if uncontested). The cold-start liquidity problem — companies won't list where capital hasn't aggregated, and vice versa — is the killer.

Calibrated view: 30% probability that TXSE captures >10% of U.S. IPO volume within 3 years. Political momentum risks fading before the technical infrastructure catches up, and the cold-start liquidity problem is a structural barrier no amount of Texas boosterism solves instantly.

The Saturday Essay: Alito's Long Game

"How Samuel Alito Is Quietly Rewriting the Conservative Legal Rulebook" (380 comments) profiles a Supreme Court justice whose approach to the law "may outlast them both" — establishment conservatism and the Trump movement. The essay argues that constitutional interpretation anchored in text and tradition, not shifting electoral preferences, is Alito's enduring contribution. It sits alongside editorial coverage of decentralized elections and private AI regulation, together painting a portrait of a jurisprudential order that trusts institutional constraints on power — except when wielded by the progressive administrative state.

Editorial Roundup and Opinion Highlights

"What Trump Voters Say About the Economy Now" tracks eroding approval among the president's own base alongside an overall declining approval rating on the economy. Democrats' financial struggles become a new test for Chairman Ken Martin — some see a "10-alarm fire" as the party regroups from 2024 (185 comments). Yale faces rising pressure to resist a settlement with the Trump administration; Sen. Richard Blumenthal, a Yale alum, has joined a growing chorus of faculty and students urging resistance. An exclusive reports that investigators found Corey Lewandowski may have been involved in improper DHS contracts, with Sen. Markwayne Mullin and White House officials briefed.

The Opinion section's Saturday Interview features Gad Saad on "Suicidal Empathy and Western Decline" — the Canadian scholar

fleeing Montreal for the U.S., interviewed by Tunku Varadarajan (471 comments). Roland Fryer's "The Economics of Friendship" explores why loneliness rises when life becomes frictionless and efficient. "How Trump's Tariffs Really 'Work'" is analyzed by the Editorial Board. Howard Schultz warns "Will Washington State Choose Stagnation Over Growth?" in Cross Country. Matthew Continetti bets on "Bet on Democrats' Midterm Enthusiasm" in Free Expression. Louise Perry's "Dear America, We're Obsessed With You." Mike Waltz takes Cuba to school at the U.N. Eugene Kontorovich and Mark Goldfeder discuss "A Congressional Campaign Against Jewish Charities." Scott W. Atlas writes "The Selfie Generation Is the Baby Boomers' Mistake." Lou Weiss on "When Your Friends All Turn 70." Matthew Hennessey on "How Your Values Stack Up — Free Expression on the Weekend." Holman W. Jenkins, Jr., examines "Trump's Crypto Impeachment?" and separately profiles a Putin oligarch speaking up "too little, too late." "Trump Tells the Truth About Iran" offers a complementary perspective on the administration's Iran posture. "How the Smithsonian Lost America's Plot," "Britain's Exploding Disability Dole," "California Is High on Illegal Marijuana" (Gavin Newsom touts a seizure as the black market flourishes), "Why Venezuela Turned Rescue Teams Away," "Did the Supreme Court Steal the Midterm Elections?," and "Palestinians Have Been Offered Peace Before" — a letter noting that neither Arafat nor his successor ever dismantled Hamas — round out a dense opinion section. The Economics of Friendship, a commentary by Roland Fryer, and "What Alan Greenspan's Legacy Might Have Been" appear as letters.

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观察者评论

翟东升——体系/结构视角

翟东升观察：2026年7月11日

今天WSJ的核心信号：美元体系的物质基础正在加速裂解。

霍尔木兹海峡非军事冲突，而是"石油-美元"循环的物理天花板。周六最后通牒把美国逼入无解困境——升级成本不可控，退让暴露虚弱。原油库存零缓冲，第五舰队扫雷能力十年未实操。底层逻辑：当储备货币的能源保障需用硬实力维护，体系已到"系统性钙化"。

SK海力士IPO表象是亚洲芯片企业的胜利，实质暴露美国产业政策的deep

contradiction——华盛顿逼苹果买Intel产能，却靠韩国芯片撑市场sentiment。TXSE挑战纽交所垄断方向正确，但cold-start流动性是物理规律，政治热情解决不了。

最危险信号：Russell 2000与S&P

500近1%分化。金融资产价格是主权信用的滞后指标——大盘靠几支芯片股撑门面时，实物经济已在卖出。

这不是市场波动，是平行体系加速成型的信号。美元体系的三根支柱——能源安全、半导体供应链、金融基础设施——正在同步裂解。金融市场的price discovery功能滞后于地缘政治的结构位移，但滞后不等于缺席。

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金灿荣——美国政治/战略相持视角

金灿荣观察：2026年7月11日

今天这个简报，信息量很大。我给大家提炼一个核心判断：美国现在正处于战略相持阶段的深度焦虑期。

你们看霍尔木兹海峡这个事。特朗普给伊朗下了最后通牒——今天到期。美国人说"周六之前不投降就开打"，结果呢？伊朗趁这窗口期拼命往外运货，第五舰队离海峡36小时航程，扫雷演练十年没搞过。这个问题其实很简单：美国的军事威慑在波斯湾已经破产了。嘴上狠话，手上没活。这就是典型的"战略防御"阶段的症状——霸权衰退，但心理上不承认。

再看半导体这条线。SK海力士在纽约IPO，一天涨了4%，带着英伟达涨了4%。美国人高兴坏了，说"芯片贸易帮华尔街扛住了伊朗打击"。但你们注意一个细节：英特尔——美国政府用行政手段强行扶持的"国家队"——到现在18A工艺还没量产。华盛顿可以逼着苹果、英伟达去下单，但逼不出成功流片。这就像什么？就像你逼着邻居家孩子认你当爹，但他亲爹台积电三十年的工艺积累你一天学不会。

再看看拉塞尔2000指数，跌了0.49%，标普500涨了0.42%。91个基点的差距——大公司靠芯片股撑着，小公司全面抛售。过去五年每次大调整之前都是这个信号。

美国的战略困境就是这么清晰：军事上打不赢，工业上追不上，政治上搞不定。全球原油库存见底，汽油出口创纪录，通胀马上反弹。特朗普连个住房法案都懒得签字——让它在桌上晾着自动生效。这不是工作疏忽，这是领导力真空。

百年未有之大变局，我再说一遍：美国在衰退中挣扎，中国在工业化基础上稳步推进。今天中国可重复使用火箭成功发射部分回收，这就是工业实力的直接体现。战略相持阶段，别急。时间在我们这边。

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宋鸿兵——货币/债务/周期视角

宋鸿兵观察：2026年7月11日

如果你把当前全球金融体系看作一个液压系统，核心问题是压力失衡——美元环流正在经历一次结构性逆转，而市场的注意力却被半导体IPO的烟花吸引，忽视了主泵的异响。

霍尔木兹海峡的星期六最后通牒，是这个系统最危险的阀门节点。美国原油库存处于危险低位，汽油和柴油出口却接近历史纪录——这意味着国内缓冲库存已被出口抽干，形成了一个典型的"反馈回路陷阱"：越是制裁伊朗、封锁海峡，越需要盟友的油，越抽空自己的库存。1941年纳粹U型潜艇在大西洋切断英国补给线时，丘吉尔说的不是"我们有多强大"，而是"我们有多少天的油"。今天五角大楼面临同样的问题：36小时航程之外的海军可以开火，但清除水雷、维持海峡畅通是一个系统工程，不是一颗炸弹能解决的。等价于你在电路板上找到一个断路点，换一个保险丝——不够。压力正在向石油市场传导。

与此同时，SK海力士的IPO点燃了半导体狂欢，NVDA单日涨4%，META涨近6%。表面看是"技术革命驱动"，如果你把资金流向看作一条河流，真正的问题是：这条河的宽度在收窄。Russell

2000当天跌0.49%，与标普500之间产生了91个基点的背离。这是经典的"窄桥"结构——大市值股票通过半导体板块吊住指数，而实体经济（小盘股）已经在卖。我在《货币战争》中反复讲过：每一次重大金融危机的起点，都不是黑天鹅，而是一个你看见了却假装没看见的背离。1893年恐慌的起点是白银价格的崩盘与铁路股票的狂欢同时发生；1907年恐慌的起点是铜信托的坍塌与股市新高一起出现。今天，半导体板块正在扮演当年铁路股票的角色——所有人都认为这一次不一样。

更大的结构性问题是美元环流的输出端正在收窄。中国成功发射并部分回收了可重复使用火箭，这不是头条新闻，但从货币体系的角度看，这是"去美元化"在技术维度上的延伸——当一个经济体能够用本国货币体系完成资本形成和技术迭代，它对SWIFT和CHIPS的依赖就会下降。而美国这边，政府通过行政手段强迫苹果和英伟达支持Intel的晶圆代工复兴——这是典型的"金融高边疆"收缩期的症状：当市场机制无法配置资源时，政府之手就必须介入。政府可以强迫客户下单，但不能强迫芯片良率达标。Intel的18A和14A制程至今没有大规模出货——这相当于一家银行发行了债券却无法兑付。

油价向CPI的传导有一个6到8周的时滞——这是系统延迟，不是风险消失。美国柴油出口创纪录意味着国内补库成本将被转嫁给全球市场，而全球市场最终会通过进口价格回馈给美国消费者。这是一个负反馈环路的闭环过程，美联储在这个环路里是被动的——它既不能降息刺激经济（通胀未消），也不能加息抑制通胀（衰退风险已现）。等价于一个阀门卡死在了中间位置。

金融高边疆的沦丧往往不是被攻破，而是从内部腐蚀的。美元环流正在逆转的信号已经摆在了台面上：霍尔木兹的油路切断、小盘股的资金枯竭、半导体的单点集中风险、政府被迫充当资本分配者——每一个都直指同一个结论：这个系统的冗余度已经被压缩到了临界点

以下。

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Consolidated briefing with Observer commentaries. Version 3. July 11, 2026.

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